CHAPTER 3

第三章

The Chineseness of Chinatown in Singapore: Chinese New Year Celebrations in a Multiracial Heritage Site

新加坡唐人街的华人特质：多种族遗产地中的农历新年庆祝活动

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Abstract

摘要

In the official narrative of the postcolonial Singaporean state, Chinatown is the cradle of Chinese community development, but such a claim can be made only retrospectively. The maintenance of Chinatown in Singapore demonstrates the official desire to establish cultural, ethnic, and historical links between a lived present and an imagined past. By extension, Chinatown is defined as a Chinese cradle on the basis of a constructed and highly essentialized Chinese identity in Singapore. This chapter suggests that an essentially new Chinatown has resulted from the state's urban redevelopment plans. No longer organic in its growth and composition, the new Chinatown nonetheless has the symbols – pagodas, red lanterns, stone lions, and Chinatown arches – that would strike the casual tourist as being intuitively Chinese. At the national level, the mere existence of the new Chinatown has reduced or simplified the diversity of Chinese communities in Singapore, subsuming the various dialect groups under the Chinese label. The transformation of Chinatown is best exemplified in its Chinese New Year celebrations, which feature the participation of other ethnic groups in Singapore, notably the Indians and Malays. The site and festivities have become multiracial, in line with the official narrative that Singapore is a multiracial and socially harmonious nation. In effect, the new Chinatown has evolved into not only a transnational heritage site but also a multiracial showroom of cultural diversity contributing to nation-building in Singapore.

在后殖民新加坡国家的官方叙事中，唐人街被视为华人社群发展的摇篮，但这一说法只能回溯性地成立。新加坡唐人街的维护体现了官方在鲜活的当下与想象的过去之间建立文化、族群和历史联系的意愿。推而广之，唐人街被定义为华人的摇篮，其基础是新加坡一种被建构出来的、高度本质化的华人身份认同。本章认为，一个本质上全新的唐人街是国家城市重建规划的产物。新唐人街在生长和构成上不再具有有机性，但它仍然保留着那些能让普通游客直观感受到"中国味"的符号——宝塔、红灯笼、石狮子和唐人街牌坊。在国家层面，新唐人街的存在本身已经缩减或简化了新加坡华人社群的多样性，将各方言群体统统归入"华人"标签之下。唐人街的转型在其农历新年庆祝活动中体现得最为典型——庆祝活动吸纳了新加坡其他族群的参与，特别是印度族和马来族。这一地点和庆典已成为多种族的，与新加坡是一

个多种族、社会和谐国家的官方叙事相一致。实际上，新唐人街不仅演变为一个跨国遗产地，也成为一个展示文化多样性的多种族展厅，为新加坡的国家建构贡献力量。

Keywords

关键词

Chinatown – Chineseness – ethnicity – multiculturalism – Singapore

唐人街 – 华人特质 – 族群 – 多元文化主义 – 新加坡

Although the nation is predominantly populated by ethnic Chinese, Singapore is in a unique position of incorporating a Chinatown, which usually denotes the urban enclave of a Chinese minority elsewhere in the world. But Singapore was a British colony, and the idea of Chinatown (Anderson 1987), as well as the notion of 'Chinese' as a distinct and singular ethnic group, is relatively modern and arguably colonial (Anderson et al. 2019, 61), so it is perhaps surprising that a Chinatown would exist in Singapore. In fact, the label 'Chinatown' appears to have been first used in connection with the Chinese quarter of Singapore in the nineteenth century, which the British colonial government called 'China-Town,' likely a verbatim translation into English of the Malay name for that quarter, 'kota China' (Anderson et al. 2019, 61). In the official narrative of the postcolonial Singaporean state, Chinatown is indisputably the 'cradle of Chinese community development' (Lim 2019, 77–111). But such a claim can be made only retrospectively. Being Chinese is never absolute, and the question of whether a person is 'more or less Chinese' is often measured by an essentialist yardstick of their commitment to so-called traditional Chinese culture and values (Wang 2003, 184). As historian Gungwu Wang (2009, 13) suggests, Chinese overseas tend to preserve essentialist cultural elements in order to 'defend their descendants from becoming rootless,' and the maintenance of Chinatown in Singapore demonstrates such a desire to establish cultural, ethnic, and historical links between a lived present and an imagined past. By extension, Chinatown is defined as the cradle of Chinese community development on the basis of a constructed and highly essentialized Chinese identity in Singapore.

尽管新加坡这个国家以华族为主体人口，但它拥有一个唐人街的状况却颇为独特——在世界其他地方，唐人街通常指的是华人少数族群的城市飞地。但新加坡曾是英国殖民地，"唐人街"这一概念（Anderson 1987）以及"华人"作为一个独特、单一族群的观念，其实是相对现代的产物，甚至可以说是殖民的产物（Anderson et al. 2019, 61），因此新加坡存在一个唐人街或许并不令人意外。事实上，"唐人街"这一标签最早似乎是在十九世纪与新加坡华人街区联系在一起使用的，英国殖民政府称其为"China-Town"，很可能是对马来语中该街区名称"kota China"的逐字英译（Anderson et al. 2019, 61）。在后殖民新加坡国家的官方叙事中，唐人街无可争议地是"华人社群发展的摇篮"（Lim 2019, 77 – 111）。但这一说法只能回溯性地成立。"华人身份"从来不是绝对的，一个人是否"更华人"或"更不华人"，往往用一把本质主义的标尺来衡量，即看他们对所谓中国传统文化和价值观的坚守程度（Wang 2003, 184）。正如历史学家王赓武（2009, 13）所指出的，海外华人倾向于保留本质主义的文化元素，以"保护他们的后代不致失去根基"，而新加坡唐人街的维护正体现了这种在鲜活的当下与想象的过去之间建立文化、族群和历史联系的意愿。推而广之，唐人街被定义为华人社群发展的摇篮，其基础是新加坡一种被建构出来的、高度本质化的华人身份认同。

In this context, then, what kind of Chinatown emerged from the Singaporean state's urban renewal program? Who helped refashion Chinatown into a key site of Chinese heritage and memory, and what motivated them to do so? This chapter suggests that an essentially new Chinatown has resulted from the urban redevelopment plans. No longer organic in its growth and composition, the new Chinatown nonetheless has the (superficial) symbols – pagodas, red lanterns, stone lions, and Chinatown arches – that would strike the casual tourist as being intuitively 'Chinese' (in the broadest sense possible). At the domestic or national level, the mere existence of the new Chinatown has reduced or simplified the diversity of Chinese communities in Singapore, subsuming the various dialect groups under the 'Chinese' label. The transformation of Chinatown is best exemplified in its Chinese New Year celebrations, which feature the participation of other ethnic groups in Singapore, notably the Indians and Malays. The site and festivities are thus multiracial, in line with the official narrative that Singapore is a multiracial and socially harmonious nation. In effect, the new Chinatown has evolved into not only a transnational heritage site but also a multiracial showroom of cultural diversity contributing to nation-building (sometimes referred to as community-building in the official narrative) in Singapore.

那么，在这一背景下，新加坡国家的城市更新计划催生了什么样的唐人街？是谁帮助将唐人街重塑为中国遗产与记忆的重要场所？又是什么动机驱使他们这样做？本章认为，一个本质上全新的唐人街是城市重建规划的产物。新唐人街在生长和构成上不再具有有机性，但它仍然拥有那些（表面的）符号——宝塔、红灯笼、石狮子和唐人街牌坊——能让普通游客直观地感受到"中国味"（在最广泛的意义上）。在国内或国家层面，新唐人街的存在本身已经缩减或简化了新加坡华人社群的多样性，将各方言群体统统归入"华人"标签之下。唐人街的转型在其农历新年庆祝活动中体现得最为典型——庆祝活动吸纳了新加坡其他族群的参与，特别是印度族和马来族。因此，这一地点和庆典是多种族的，与新加坡是一个多种族、社会和谐国家的官方叙事相一致。实际上，新唐人街不仅演变为一个跨国遗产地，也成为一个展示文化多样性的多种族展厅，为新加坡的国家建构（在官方叙事中有时也称为社群建设）贡献力量。

As a result of this chapter's focus on the construction of Chinatown and Chinese New Year celebrations into multiracial sites, it analyses accounts in English-language newspapers, which constitute a mutually intelligible platform allowing Singaporeans of different races to articulate their views. By covering the activities, concerns, and tensions of Singaporeans and revealing daily bottom-up struggles in nation-building, local newspapers, rather than the foreign Anglophone press, are vital sources of information. Singapore's newspapers, appearing in a variety of languages such as Chinese, English, Malay, and Tamil, are under state control, closely monitored if not heavily censored by the authorities. English-language newspapers, while not direct translations of their Chinese-language counterparts, thus offer similar content and coverage; consulting them alone would not obscure an alternative 'Chinese' take or contradict the concept of a bordered memory. On the basis that they provide rich longitudinal data with which to examine public perceptions and hence the social making of Chinatown as a consequence of state actions and directives, this chapter suggests that Chinatown and Chinese New Year celebrations have not only been historicized but also racialized in postcolonial Singapore,

whose state has replicated the colonial practice of merging otherwise diverse groups for effective control and governance by manipulating collective and social memories.

由于本章聚焦于唐人街和农历新年庆祝活动如何被建构为多种族场所，因此分析了英文报纸上的报道——这些报纸构成了一个相互理解的平台，让不同种族的新加坡人能够表达他们的观点。地方报纸而非外国英文报刊，通过报道新加坡人的活动、关切和紧张关系，揭示国家建构中日常的、自下而上的斗争，因而是重要的信息来源。新加坡的报纸以中文、英文、马来文和泰米尔文等多种语言出版，均处于国家控制之下，受到当局的密切监视甚至严格审查。英文报纸虽然不是中文报纸的直接翻译，但提供了相似的内容和报道范围；仅查阅英文报纸并不会遮蔽另一种"华人"视角，也不会与"有边界的记忆"这一概念相矛盾。基于这些报纸提供了丰富的纵向数据，可用于考察公众认知，进而考察唐人街作为国家行为和指令的结果而被社会建构的过程，本章认为，在新加坡后殖民时期，唐人街和农历新年庆祝活动不仅被历史化了，也被种族化了——新加坡国家复制了殖民时期的做法，通过操纵集体记忆和社会记忆，将原本多元的群体合并起来，以实现有效的控制和治理。

This chapter comprises five sections. Following a brief overview of Chinatown's history, it explores the process of self-orientalism in the new Chinatown and how the Singaporean state has redesigned its layout for tourist appeal. It then sketches the historical background of the ethnic Chinese and the multiplicity of Chinese dialect groups in Singapore. The fourth section discusses how different Chinese dialect groups have forged the Chinese New Year celebrations as an event and as heritage. Finally, the chapter examines how the Chinatown of Singapore has become part of a nation-building project codifying the Chinese as one of three key races that constitute the Singaporean nation. Ultimately, the 'Chinatown-ness' of Chinatown is intimately tied to its Chineseness, and the dialect groups hailing from Fujian and Guangdong are classified and collectively known as 'Chinese' among the races in Singapore.[1]

本章共分五个部分。在简要回顾唐人街历史之后，探讨新唐人街中的自我东方化过程，以及新加坡国家如何为吸引游客而重新设计其布局。然后勾勒新加坡华族的历史背景以及新加坡华人各方言群体的多样性。第四部分讨论不同的华人方言群体如何将农历新年庆祝活动打造为一个事件和一种遗产。最后，本章考察新加坡唐人街如何成为国家建构工程的一部分，将华人界定为构成新加坡国家的三大主要种族之一。归根结底，唐人街的"唐人街性"与其华人特质紧密相连，而来自福建和广东的各方言群体在新加坡的种族分类中被统称为"华人"。[1]

1
Chinatown at a Glance

一
唐人街概览

The history of Chinatown in Singapore has been well documented and does not require much recounting here (Yeoh and Kong 2012; Lim 2019). In the 1820s, the colonial authorities devised a town plan, and a district southwest of the Singapore River was appropriated to accommodate settlers from China. Aware of the various dialect groups (bangs) nested within the broad category of Chinese, the authorities allocated Chinese settlers arriving from different

provinces or localities their own subdistricts (Lim 2019, 79). The five major dialect groups were Cantonese, Hainanese, Hakka, Hokkien (the most numerous), and Teochew. Each of these groups set up their own clan associations to promote welfare and mutual aid among themselves. Following China's defeat by Britain in the First Opium War (1839–1842) and its opening up to foreign maritime trade, coolies from the coastal provinces of Fujian and Guangdong arrived in Singapore in unprecedented numbers. Within years, Chinatown gained notoriety as an overcrowded and unsanitary district. But it also became highly sophisticated in terms of social makeup, variety of occupations, and cultural expression. It continued, somewhat unregulated and unsupervised, to grow in density—though not in size—until 1971, when the newly formed Singaporean government (Singapore gained independence in 1965) announced that about 100,000 people living in Chinatown would be resettled under the urban renewal program. Throughout the 1970s and 1980s, Chinatown residents (notably the 'Samsui women' who hailed from the Samsui District, Guangdong Province, and worked on construction sites), shopkeepers, and street hawkers were relocated to public housing estates outside Chinatown (Lim 2019, 108–9). By the mid-1980s, Chinatown had been hollowed out, emptied of its original—or organic—inhabitants and proprietors, and state attention was redirected to preserve its heritage (whatever remained of it) and redevelop it into a historic district (Urban Redevelopment Authority 1995).

新加坡唐人街的历史已有充分记载，此处无需过多赘述（Yeoh and Kong 2012; Lim 2019）。十九世纪二十年代，殖民当局制定了城市规划，将新加坡河西南岸的一个区划拨出来安置来自中国的移民。当局意识到"华人"这一大类之下嵌套着不同的方言群体（帮），于是将来自不同省份或地区的华人移民分配到各自的小区（Lim 2019, 79）。五大方言群体分别是：广府人、海南人、客家人、福建人（人数最多）和潮州人。每个群体都建立了自己的会馆，以促进内部福利和互助。第一次鸦片战争（1839 – 1842）中国战败并开放海上对外贸易后，来自福建和广东沿海省份的苦力以前所未有的规模抵达新加坡。短短数年间，唐人街就因拥挤不堪、卫生条件恶劣而声名狼藉。但它同时在社会构成、职业多样性和文化表达方面也变得高度复杂。它在某种程度上处于无人监管的状态下持续增长——密度不断增加，但面积并未扩大——直到1971年，新成立的新加坡政府（新加坡于1965年独立）宣布，居住在唐人街的约10万人将在城市更新计划下被重新安置。整个二十世纪七十和八十年代，唐人街居民（特别是来自广东省三水地区、在建筑工地做工的"三水女人"）、店主和街头小贩都被迁移到唐人街以外的公共组屋区（Lim 2019, 108 – 9）。到二十世纪八十年代中期，唐人街已被掏空，原有的——或者说有机的——居民和店主都已迁离，国家的注意力转向保护其遗产（不管还剩下什么），并将其重新开发为一个历史街区（Urban Redevelopment Authority 1995）。

To be sure, Chinatown was not the only ethnic district transformed by the state into a heritage site. During the 1980s, the state's Urban Redevelopment Authority (URA) designated key conservation areas such as Kampong Glam (for the Malays) and Little India (for the Indians) alongside Chinatown to reflect the dominant organizing framework of race in Singapore. As a result of URA's conservation master plan, all three districts retained their urban form amid the high-rise, high-density built environment of Singapore and were hailed as the nation's unique heritage sites by the tourism board. Conservation guidelines applied to these sites allowed adaptive reoccupation for new

commercial activities, mostly related to tourism, along with older businesses now in decline. While Little India has remained 'an ethnically bound site articulated and exemplified by the material culture and social practices of an Indian sub-population' (and is thus considered a more 'authentic' site, see Yeo 2020, 184–185), Chinatown and Kampong Glam have become lifestyle enclaves for middle-class Singaporeans and their creative industries. Singapore is surrounded by supposedly 'Malay' neighbours (i.e., Indonesia and Malaysia) and feels the need to downplay the potential antagonism between 'native' Malays and 'outsider' Chinese in the country; the preservation of Little India is thus politically expedient. From the perspective of the state, though, these 'less authentic' heritage sites must also exist, regardless of their appeal, in order to ensure that each so-called official race has its own historic site. In preparation for merger with Malaya in the early 1960s, the state had highlighted Singapore's Malay identity; it has continued to recognize Malay as the national language and preserve Kampong Glam as an 'authentic' or 'organic' Malay district to showcase its Malay past to Indonesia and Malaysia (Rahim 2009, 1–2). Serving less a geopolitically symbolic function than a practical purpose of locating ethnic Chinese within the state's racial framework, Chinatown reflects the demographic reality of a Chinese majority in Singapore—it would be conspicuous not to include it in the conservation plan if Kampong Glam and Little India were embraced or institutionalized as key sites of national heritage.

诚然，唐人街并不是唯一一个被国家转变为遗产地的族群街区。二十世纪八十年代，国家城市重建局（URA）在指定主要保护区时，除了唐人街之外，还包括了甘榜格南（马来人区）和小印度（印度人区），以体现新加坡占主导地位的种族组织框架。由于市区重建局保护总体规划的实施，这三个街区在新加坡高层、高密度的建筑环境中保留了它们的城市形态，并被旅游局誉为国家独特的遗产地。适用于这些地点的保护准则允许适应性再利用，发展新的商业活动——主要与旅游相关——同时保留现已衰落的老店铺。小印度仍然是"一个受族群边界约束的场所，由印度次群体的物质文化和社会实践所表达和体现"（因此被认为是一个更"正宗"的场所，见Yeo 2020, 184 – 185），而唐人街和甘榜格南已成为新加坡中产阶级及其创意产业的生活方式飞地。新加坡被所谓的"马来"邻国（即印度尼西亚和马来西亚）所包围，因此有必要淡化国内"本土"马来人与"外来"华人之间潜在的对抗性；保护小印度在政治上是权宜之计。但从国家的角度来看，这些"不那么正宗"的遗产地也必须存在，无论其吸引力如何，以确保每个所谓的官方种族都有自己的历史遗址。在二十世纪六十年代初为与马来亚合并做准备时，国家曾强调新加坡的马来身份；它继续承认马来语为国语，并将甘榜格南保留为一个"正宗的"或"有机的"马来街区，以向印度尼西亚和马来西亚展示其马来历史（Rahim 2009, 1 – 2）。唐人街与其说发挥地缘政治象征功能，不如说是服务于一个实际目的——将华族定位在国家的种族框架之内——它反映了新加坡华人占多数的人口现实：如果甘榜格南和小印度都被纳入或制度化为国家遗产的重要场所，而唐人街不被纳入保护计划，那才是反常的。

2
Orientalism in Chinatown

二
唐人街中的东方主义

In the wake of independence, the Singaporean government was building new housing estates across much of the island, and the rebuilding of old Singapore gained impetus. The government depopulated Chinatown by relocating its inhabitants to the new estates in phases. But contrary to the common perception among Singaporeans that the government has been indiscriminate in demolishing old buildings, it did take steps to ensure, as far as possible, that sites of historical significance did not disappear (Blackburn and Tan 2015). By the 1980s, however, some Singaporeans had grown concerned about the bulldozing and rate of transformation in Chinatown. One of these was chief of the tourism board, who called for the preservation of buildings and lifestyles of old Singapore before they were gone forever (The Straits Times 1980, 6). Like the Singapore River, Chinatown became a 'veritable symbol of old-world Singapore' (The Straits Times 1982, 16).

> 独立后，新加坡政府在全岛大部分地区建设新的组屋区，旧新加坡的重建也获得了动力。政府通过分阶段将居民迁移到新组屋区，使唐人街人口减少。但与新加坡人普遍认为政府不加区别地拆除旧建筑的看法相反，政府确实采取了措施，尽可能确保具有历史意义的地点不致消失（Blackburn and Tan 2015）。然而到了二十世纪八十年代，一些新加坡人开始对唐人街的推土机和改造速度感到担忧。其中一位是旅游局局长，他呼吁在旧新加坡的建筑和生活方式永远消失之前加以保护（The Straits Times 1980, 6）。与新加坡河一样，唐人街成为"旧新加坡地地道道的象征"（The Straits Times 1982, 16）。

In revamping Chinatown, the Singaporean authorities sought advice from foreign experts and inspiration from foreign heritage sites. They invited curators from Southeast Asian countries to visit Chinatown and other sites and offer suggestions for preserving them (Singapore Monitor 1983, 4). As Singaporeans readily conceded, 'Chinatown no longer rivals Kowloon [in Hong Kong] as an oriental oasis in the midst of a modern international city' (Singapore Monitor 1984a, 15). The tourism board thus set up a task force to present Singapore 'as both the epitome of oriental mystique and a high-tech entertainment centre in a few years' time' (Business Times 1984b, 1). According to the task force, Chinatown should be 'given a reprieve from further urban renewal' (Business Times 1984b, 1). The goal was to turn Chinatown into an area that would give tourists an insight into what life was like for the old Chinese immigrants. But a contradiction existed—a complete restoration of Chinatown (i.e., returning it to the way it was) might not be welcomed by tourists. As a developer suggested, 'There is a need to paint a new image of Chinatown to tourists because the idea of Singapore Chinatown would immediately conjure up images of dilapidated buildings as seen in the Fifties and Sixties with no proper sanitation' (Singapore Monitor 1985c, 12). The tourist board noted that 'while Singapore's already few historical landmarks were being mowed away, Hongkong, Thailand and Malaysia were aggressively selling their different cultures and way of life to curious foreigners' (Business Times 1985b, 8). In response, officials decided to create Chinatown according to the following concept: 'A wealth of quaint little shops can be found in the maze of streets that make up Chinatown; musty old shops tucked away in weathered buildings sell foodstuff, fresh and dried; Chinese pharmacies and their imposing medicine cabinets with hundreds of tiny drawers containing the most exotic cures; peddlers with hand-crafted Chinese

opera masks; paper houses and life-sized paper cars sold to be burned at funerals' (The Straits Times 1988, 35).

在改造唐人街时，新加坡当局寻求外国专家的建议和外国遗产地的灵感。他们邀请东南亚国家的策展人参观唐人街和其他地点，为保护这些遗址提供建议（Singapore Monitor 1983, 4）。正如新加坡人自己坦率承认的那样，"唐人街已不再能与[香港]九龙相匹敌，不再是现代国际都市中的东方绿洲"（Singapore Monitor 1984a, 15）。旅游局因此成立了一个特别工作组，要在几年内将新加坡打造为"既是东方神秘气质的缩影，又是高科技娱乐中心"（Business Times 1984b, 1）。根据工作组的建议，唐人街应该"暂缓进一步的城市更新"（Business Times 1984b, 1）。目标是将唐人街变成一个能让游客了解老一代华人移民生活的地方。但这里存在一个矛盾——完全恢复唐人街（即恢复它原来的样子）可能不受游客欢迎。正如一位开发商所建议的："有必要向游客描绘唐人街的新形象，因为一提到新加坡唐人街，人们立刻就会联想到五六十年代那种没有适当卫生设施的破旧建筑"（Singapore Monitor 1985c, 12）。旅游局注意到，"当新加坡本来就不多的历史地标正在被铲除时，香港、泰国和马来西亚却在积极地向好奇的外国人推销他们不同的文化和生活方式"（Business Times 1985b, 8）。作为回应，官员们决定按照以下理念来打造唐人街："在构成唐人街的迷宫般的街道中，可以找到大量古色古香的小店铺；藏在斑驳建筑里的陈旧老店出售新鲜和干货食品；中药铺及其气派的药柜，上面有数百个小抽屉，装着最稀奇古怪的药材；叫卖手工制作的中国戏曲面具的小贩；出售给葬礼上焚烧的纸扎房屋和真人大小的纸车"（The Straits Times 1988, 35）。

Within years, Chinatown became known as an Oriental town where 'shoppers can look forward to buying oriental goods such as calligraphy, traditional arts and craft, and medicine' (TODAY 2003, 6). An orientalist imagination, articulated in state-controlled newspapers through quaint, reified, and stereotypical representations of Chineseness and Chinatown-ness, has characterized the fashioning of Chinatown. Much of this orientalization of Chinatown has occurred with the consent and participation of the ethnic Chinese themselves (Anderson et al. 2019, 27). In the case of Singapore, ethnic Chinese political leaders, urban planners, and tourism board directors have often inadvertently engaged in a form of self-orientalism to attract foreign tourists, mostly from the developed world of former colonial powers such as Britain and Japan. For them, Chinatown has to appeal to foreign tourists in a universalistic way, such that it can instantly strike them as being Chinese in the broadest sense possible. At the same time, however, it has to be distinguished from, for example, other heritage sites in the region or the Chinatowns of London and Yokohama so that it can highlight Singapore's uniqueness as a preferred tourist destination. According to the tourism board, the defining feature of Singapore's Chinatown lies perhaps in 'its blend of old and new, with historic temples and traditional medicinal halls sitting alongside bold new bars and trendy lifestyle shops' (Singapore Tourism Board n.d.). But this is a Chinatown that is vastly different from the one of colonial times. The depopulation of the old colonial Chinatown deprived the district of an organic community that could otherwise expand and develop along its own trajectory. Chinatown has become a theme park of sorts, geared almost entirely toward attracting foreign tourists and those occasional local Chinese residents shopping for Chinese New Year festivities. Its existence, or the validity of its existence, rests on the assumption of a broad, singular, and unified Chinese community in Sin-

gapore, which has been actively constructed by the state since independence (see Figure 3.1).

短短数年间，唐人街就以一个东方小镇而闻名，"购物者可以期待买到书法、传统工艺品和药品等东方商品"（TODAY 2003, 6）。一种东方主义想象——通过国家控制的报纸以古雅、物化和刻板的方式再现华人特质和唐人街性——塑造了唐人街的打造过程。唐人街的这种东方化在很大程度上是在华族自身的同意和参与下发生的（Anderson et al. 2019, 27）。就新加坡而言，华人政治领袖、城市规划者和旅游局主管往往在不经意间陷入一种自我东方化，以吸引外国游客——主要来自英国和日本等前殖民大国的发达国家。对他们来说，唐人街必须以一种普遍主义的方式吸引外国游客，让他们能立刻直观地感受到最广泛意义上的"中国味"。但同时，它又必须与该地区的其他遗产地或伦敦、横滨的唐人街区分开来，以突出新加坡作为首选旅游目的地的独特性。根据旅游局的说法，新加坡唐人街的决定性特征也许在于"它融合了新旧元素，历史悠久的寺庙和传统药堂与大胆新颖的酒吧和时髦的生活方式店铺比邻而立"（Singapore Tourism Board n.d.）。但这个唐人街与殖民时代的唐人街已经大不相同。旧殖民唐人街人口的减少使这一街区失去了一个有机的社群——否则它本可以沿着自己的轨迹扩张和发展。唐人街已变成一个主题公园式的地方，几乎完全以吸引外国游客和那些偶尔来采购农历年货的本地华人居民为目的。它的存在，或者说它存在的合理性，建立在新加坡存在一个广泛的、单一的、统一的华人社群这一假设之上——而这个社群自独立以来一直由国家积极建构（见图3.1）。



Figure 3.1 Pagoda Street, which features Chinatown's street market

图3.1 宝塔街，以唐人街的街市为特色

Courtesy of Wikimedia

图片来源：维基共享资源

3
Becoming 'Chinese' in Singapore

三
在新加坡成为「华人」

In colonial Singapore, sojourners and settlers from China were organized according to bangs (i.e., groups structured along dialect lines), which maintained geographical affiliations to their own native places. The Straits-born Chinese, whose ancestors hailed from Fujian Province and had lived in Malacca for generations, were grouped with the Hokkiens in the colonial censuses. Throughout colonial history (and to the present), the five major dialect groups remained the Hokkiens, Teochews, Cantonese, Hainanese, and Hakkas. Bang politics were complex and wide-reaching, encompassing both horizontal and vertical intra- and inter-dialect group activities and relationships. They included the management of temples, burial groups, kinship and territorial clan associations, and occupational and trade organizations (Lim 2019, 117). A clan comprised people sharing a surname and those originating in the same geographical locality (xiang) who spoke the same dialect. The colonial government made very few provisions for settlers and sojourners alike, so clan associations and other mutual-aid organizations became responsible for their clansmen's welfare and personal safety, providing a slew of social services on behalf of the authorities.

在殖民时期的新加坡，来自中国的旅居者和移民按照"帮"（即按方言划分的群体）组织起来，这些群体与各自的家乡保持着地理上的联系。海峡出生的华人——其祖先来自福建省，已在马六甲生活了好几代——在殖民人口普查中被归入福建人群体。在整个殖民历史中（直到今天），五大方言群体一直是：福建人、潮州人、广府人、海南人和客家人。帮权政治复杂而广泛，包括方言群体内部和之间横向与纵向的活动和关系。它们包括寺庙管理、丧葬团体、血缘和地缘会馆以及行业组织（Lim 2019, 117）。一个会馆由同姓和来自同一地理地区（乡）、说同一方言的人组成。殖民政府对移民和旅居者几乎没有提供什么保障，因此会馆和其他互助组织开始负责其成员的福利和人身安全，代当局提供一系列社会服务。

Since independence, however, the role of dialect group associations in the social life of ethnic Chinese has been transformed. Although the Singaporean government has emphasized individual responsibility for one's provisions in life, the growing prosperity of the nation has allowed it to subsidize if not cover the costs of housing, medical care, and other social services for citizens. As a result, dialect group associations have been reduced to being custodians of heritage, playing only a supporting role in ensuring the welfare of their members. More importantly, the state categorizes all citizens using the CMIO model: Chinese, Malay, Indian, and Others. Essential information on every Singaporean's identity card includes racial classification. Race follows a patrilineal structure and is ascribed at birth. Race is thus reinforced as a grounded and visible identity, with the state insisting that everyone is a 'hyphenated citizen' (Reddy 2016, 58). Whether or not people are born or speak Hokkien, Teochew, Cantonese, Hainanese, or Hakka, they are classified as 'Chinese' on their identity card. The multiplicity within each racial category is not acknowledged by the authorities, and differences within and between the categories are essentialized (Reddy 2016, 59).

然而，自独立以来，方言群体会馆在华族社会生活中的角色已经转变。尽管新加坡政府强调个人对自己生活保障的责任，但国家日益繁荣的经济使其有能力补贴甚至承担公民的住房、医疗和其他社会服务费用。因此，方言群体会馆已降格为遗产的守护者，在保障成员福利方面只扮演辅助角色。

更重要的是，国家使用CMIO模式对所有公民进行分类：华人（Chinese）、马来人（Malay）、印度人（Indian）和其他（Others）。每个新加坡人身份证上的基本信息都包括种族分类。种族遵循父系结构，出生时即被赋予。因此，种族被强化为一种扎根的、可见的身份，国家坚持认为每个人都是"连字符公民"（Reddy 2016, 58）。无论人们是否出生或说福建话、潮州话、广府话、海南话或客家话，他们在身份证上都被归类为"华人"。当局不承认每个种族类别内部的多样性，类别内部和类别之间的差异被本质化了（Reddy 2016, 59）。

The 'Speak Mandarin Campaign,' launched in 1979, has made the most lasting impact on the sociolinguistic profile of the Chinese dialect groups. After independence, the government decided to 'nationalize' the education system by merging all the existing language streams (English, Mandarin, Malay, and Tamil) into one national stream. Since 1966, education officials have promoted bilingual education, making it compulsory for all students to study both English and their 'mother tongue' so that they can preserve their 'designated' cultural roots (Kuo 2019, 736). To assimilate all the dialect groups into the 'Chinese' category, the government promoted Mandarin to replace the use of dialects. Radio and television stations were restricted to airing Mandarin programs. Major newspapers, already effectively under state control, supported the campaign with editorials and commentaries. Chinese courses were offered to the public at community centres. Schools were instructed to use the simplified Chinese script and the hanyu pinyin in standard Mandarin to spell students' names. By the time the campaign was launched, the communist threat was virtually non-existent, and the loyalty of Chinese Singaporeans was no longer to mainland China, so the government was sufficiently confident in the political stability of the nation to encourage the use of Mandarin. To avoid offending the sensibilities of the Indians and Malays, officials stressed that the campaign targeted only the Chinese. This suggests that although the leaders of Singapore (i.e., Lee Kuan Yew and the People's Action Party) are primarily Chinese, they keep a watchful eye on ethnic issues and strive to reduce ethnic tensions to the minimum (Barr 2014). Barely a decade into the campaign, Mandarin had almost completely replaced dialects to become the common language, and Mandarin has become the language of choice among Chinese Singaporeans (Kuo 2019, 735–754). The illiterate immigrants from China who spoke only local dialects have been transformed into citizen-users of the 'elite' Mandarin language (Leong 2016), decisively merging all the dialect groups into the officially unitary 'Chinese' community in Singapore. Contemporary Chinatown is a microcosm or symbol of this national merger, as the following discussion on the 'Sinicization' of Chinese New Year celebrations will show.

1979年发起的"讲华语运动"对方言群体的社会语言面貌产生了最深远的影响。独立后，政府决定将所有现有的语言源流（英语、华语、马来语和泰米尔语）合并为一个国家源流，使教育系统"国有化"。自1966年以来，教育官员推行双语教育，要求所有学生必须同时学习英语和他们的"母语"，以便保留他们"被指定的"文化根源（Kuo 2019, 736）。为了将所有方言群体同化到"华人"类别中，政府推广华语以取代方言的使用。广播电台和电视台被限制只能播放华语节目。主要报纸实际上已处于国家控制之下，以社论和评论支持这项运动。社区中心向公众开设中文课程。学校被要求使用简体字和标准华语的汉语拼音来拼写学生的名字。到这项运动发起时，共产主义威胁已几乎不存在，新加坡华人的忠诚也不再指向中国大陆，因此政府对国家的政治稳定有足够信心来鼓励使用华语。为了

避免冒犯印度族和马来族的感情，官员们强调这项运动只针对华人。这表明，尽管新加坡领导人（即李光耀和人民行动党）主要是华人，但他们密切关注族群问题，努力将族群紧张关系降至最低（Barr 2014）。运动开始仅十年，华语就几乎完全取代了方言成为通用语，华语已成为新加坡华人的首选语言（Kuo 2019, 735 – 754）。那些只会说当地方言的来自中国的文盲移民，已经转变为"精英"华语的公民使用者（Leong 2016），果断地将所有方言群体合并为新加坡官方统一的"华人"社群。当代唐人街就是这种国家合并的缩影或象征，正如接下来关于农历新年庆祝活动"中国化"的讨论将表明的那样。

4
Chinese New Year Festival in Chinatown

四
唐人街的农历新年庆典

For the unitary Chinese community in contemporary Singapore, Chinese New Year is the festival or occasion that coalesce and congeal memories about its past as an amalgamation of different bangs or dialect groups. The biggest Chinese New Year celebrations are held in Chinatown every year. Unlike districts of its kind in other countries, the Chinatown of Singapore hosts somewhat subdued celebrations, most of which are planned by the state's grassroots organizations. During the 1970s, the government enacted a gradual ban on firecrackers in Chinese New Year celebrations out of concern for public safety (New Nation 1971, 2); the ban became total in 1972. Although there were areas—all outside Chinatown—designated for setting off firecrackers during the Chinese New Year, Singaporeans were reluctant to use them, thereby suggesting the 'symbolic significance of [place] has deep roots not only in individual emotion but also in tradition' (The Straits Times 1972, 20). Chinatown remained a premier shopping district of choice for Chinese New Year goodies. It featured an open market for eatables and wearables visited by locals and tourists alike, in line with the tourism board's packaging of Singapore as a 'shopper's paradise, a gourmet's paradise and a garden city … with unique cultural mix blended harmoniously' (Business Times 1978, 33). The ethnic trappings of the festivities remained: 'street parades, lion and dragon dances […] costume and masks' (The Straits Times 1979, 4).

对于当代新加坡统一的华人社群来说，农历新年是一个节日或场合，它凝聚并固化了关于其作为不同"帮"或方言群体融合体之过去的记忆。每年最大规模的农历新年庆祝活动都在唐人街举行。与其他国家的同类街区不同，新加坡唐人街举办的庆祝活动相对克制，其中大部分由国家基层组织策划。二十世纪七十年代，出于公共安全考虑，政府逐步禁止农历新年庆祝活动中的鞭炮（New Nation 1971, 2）；禁令于1972年全面实施。尽管在唐人街以外划定了一些区域供农历新年期间燃放鞭炮，但新加坡人不愿在那里燃放，这表明"[场所]的象征意义不仅深深植根于个人情感，也植根于传统"（The Straits Times 1972, 20）。唐人街仍然是采购年货的首选主要商业区。它设有一个露天市场，出售食品和服饰，本地人和游客都会光顾，这与旅游局将新加坡包装为"购物者天堂、美食家天堂和花园城市……独特文化和谐融合"的定位相一致（Business Times 1978, 33）。庆祝活动的族群装饰依然存在："街头游行、舞狮舞龙……服装和面具"（The Straits Times 1979, 4）。

Street hawking became illegal in 1983, so it was only during the Chinese New Year Festival that food vendors could be seen operating in the alleys and lanes of Chinatown, which became a sight, or spectacle, in its own right. But for many Chinese Singaporeans, Chinatown was no longer the same without the street hawkers. With the hawkers relocated in a new sprawling indoor complex within the district, the streets that had endowed Chinatown with colour and vibrancy became empty, and the area increasingly 'resemble[d] a ghost town' unless the Chinese New Year was coming (The Straits Times 1984a, 1). But while the allure of Chinatown had diminished among Singaporeans, it remained popular with foreign tourists. In 1984, the depopulated and revamped Chinatown became Singapore's most popular tourist attraction. Approximately half of Singapore's visitors went to Chinatown, according to estimates (The Straits Times 1984b, 12). As a result, for at least a while, Chinatown was accorded top priority in preservation efforts in the government's 'all-out bid to woo tourists' (Business Times 1984a, 1). Community leaders of Chinatown cooperated with the authorities. In 1985, they organized a large Spring Festival fair filled with 'cherry blossoms from China, Chinese sausages, waxed ducks, bonsai plants, Chinese wayangs, lion and dragon dances […] [complete with] traditional Chinese music piped into the streets' (Singapore Monitor 1984b, 3). According to these leaders, who included proprietors and residents of the district, they were determined to work closely with the tourism board and 'revive the gaiety and festive atmosphere of Chinatown, even if only for just a month' (Singapore Monitor 1984b, 3). Referencing other Chinatowns in the world, the tourism board also erected four Chinatown arches at the ends of two main roads in Chinatown (Singapore Monitor 1985a, 1). Although it is not clear where the tourism board had received its inspiration, that officials created something entirely new in Chinatown—the arches—suggests that they were remaking rather than preserving the district.

1983年，街头叫卖被定为非法，因此只有在农历新年期间，才能在唐人街的小巷里看到食品摊贩经营——这本身就成了一道风景或奇观。但对许多新加坡华人来说，没有了街头小贩的唐人街已不再是原来的样子。小贩被迁移到街区内一个新的大型室内综合设施后，那些曾赋予唐人街色彩和活力的街道变得空荡，除非农历新年即将到来，否则该地区越来越"像一座鬼城"（The Straits Times 1984a, 1）。但是，尽管唐人街在新加坡人中的吸引力下降了，它在外国游客中仍然受欢迎。1984年，人口减少、经过改造的唐人街成为新加坡最受欢迎的旅游景点。据估计，大约一半到新加坡的游客会去唐人街（The Straits Times 1984b, 12）。因此，至少在一段时间内，唐人街在政府"全力招揽游客"的保护工作中被列为最优先事项（Business Times 1984a, 1）。唐人街的社区领袖与当局合作。1985年，他们组织了一场大型春节庙会，摆满了"来自中国的樱花、腊肠、腊鸭、盆景、中国地方戏、舞狮舞龙……[还有]传统中国音乐播放到街道上"（Singapore Monitor 1984b, 3）。据这些包括街区店主和居民在内的领袖表示，他们决心与旅游局密切合作，"重振唐人街的欢乐和节日气氛，哪怕只有一个月"（Singapore Monitor 1984b, 3）。参考世界其他地方的唐人街，旅游局还在唐人街两条主要道路的两端竖立了四座唐人街牌坊（Singapore Monitor 1985a, 1）。虽然不清楚旅游局的灵感来自何处，但官员们在唐人街创造了全新的东西——牌坊——这表明他们是在改造而不是保护这个街区。

But the focus of Chinatown preservation efforts did not fall entirely on tourists. Officials and retailers understood the need for Chinatown to stay relevant to everyday life in Singapore and to the so-called heritage of Chinese Singapor-

eans. The tourism board appealed to locals to help 'preserve the Chinatown way of life' by patronizing the shops in Chinatown, which faced competition from the large, airconditioned retail store chains that imported Chinese New Year products in bulk from China (Singapore Monitor 1985c, 2). But trade remained slow for shopkeepers because people increasingly preferred 'everything in their own housing estates [to save on] transport costs' (The Straits Times 1985a, 9). Officials did not give up, however, and endeavoured to 'get people, both tourists and locals, to flock to the streets [of Chinatown] curious of the goings-on' (Singapore Monitor 1985c, 20). They emphasized the 'authenticity' of festivities there: 'Ladies in authentic period costumes will give us an insight into how Chinese women in the old days dressed'; 'Mr. Lee Dai Soh, well-known Cantonese storyteller, will tell half-forgotten tales reflecting Chinese customs and beliefs—like how the Chinese used to name their sons and daughters' (Singapore Monitor 1985c, 20); 'the celebration of the year for the community, and the operas, dances, drum rolls and display of skills reflect the Chinese way of ushering in happiness, luck and prosperity' (Business Times 1985a, 6). But as a journalist suggested, 'You cannot recreate a Chinatown. If you try it ends up being too cosmetic, pristine and artificial. A little seediness adds to the atmosphere and even to the excitement' (Singapore Monitor 1985e, 4). And as sceptics remarked, the annual crowds that packed Chinatown '[did] not necessarily imply a revival of the old times when the Lunar New Year was the event of the year' (The Straits Times 1985b, 12). Growing affluence meant that luxuries once reserved for the Chinese New Year could be enjoyed all year round. Nevertheless, Chinatown remained important, at least for some journalists and community leaders, to the 'preservation of the ethnic identity of Chinese Singaporeans' (The Straits Times 1985b, 12). It was this intangible aspect that the tangible Chinatown would help preserve. As many people observed, Chinatown's annual test of popularity and significance came after the new year; it failed to retain the attention and crowds once the celebrations were over (The Straits Times 1985b, 12).

但唐人街保护工作的重点并不完全落在游客身上。官员和零售商明白，唐人街需要与新加坡的日常生活以及新加坡华人所谓的遗产保持关联。旅游局呼吁本地居民光顾唐人街的店铺，以帮助"保护唐人街的生活方式"——这些店铺面临着来自大型空调零售连锁店的竞争，后者从中国批量进口年货（Singapore Monitor 1985c, 2）。但店主们的生意仍然清淡，因为人们越来越倾向于"在自己的组屋区购买一切[以节省]交通费用"（The Straits Times 1985a, 9）。然而官员们没有放弃，努力"让人们——包括游客和本地人——涌向[唐人街的]街道，对正在发生的事情感到好奇"（Singapore Monitor 1985c, 20）。他们强调那里庆祝活动的"真实性"："穿着正宗古装的女士将让我们了解古代中国女性的穿着方式"；"著名的广府说书人李戴索先生将讲述几乎被遗忘的故事，反映中国的习俗和信仰——比如中国人过去如何给儿女取名"（Singapore Monitor 1985c, 20）；"这是社群一年中最重要的庆祝活动，戏曲、舞蹈、鼓声和技艺表演反映了中国人迎接幸福、好运和繁荣的方式"（Business Times 1985a, 6）。但正如一位记者所说："你无法重建一个唐人街。如果你尝试，结果会变得太表面、太干净、太人工化。一点破败感反而增添了气氛，甚至增添了刺激感"（Singapore Monitor 1985e, 4）。正如怀疑论者所言，每年挤满唐人街的人群"并不一定意味着农历新年曾是一年中头等大事的旧时光的复兴"（The Straits Times 1985b, 12）。日益富裕意味着曾经为农历新年保留的奢侈品现在全年都可以享受。尽管如此，至少对一些记者和社区领袖来说，唐人街对于"保存新加坡华人的族群身份"仍然重要（The

Straits Times 1985b, 12）。正是这种无形的方面，有形的唐人街将帮助予以保护。正如许多人观察到的，唐人街每年的人气和重要性考验是在新年之后；一旦庆祝活动结束，它就无法留住人们的注意力和人群（The Straits Times 1985b, 12）。

Despite such discouraging news, the tourism board and community leaders never gave up. In preparation for the 1987 Chinese New Year celebrations, they set up a Chinese cultural town within Chinatown, which showcased a potpourri of shops selling antiques, Chinese herbs, bonsai, dim sum, and crafts of vanishing tradesmen. The cultural town was designed to be a 'quaint,' 'typical bustling Chinese town, [and] each of the 32 shops will be decked with a red banner and carry its own special signboards' (The Straits Times 1986b, 32). But despite the organizers' best efforts, 'the Lunar New Year [in Chinatown] appears to be getting quieter every year as if to give the lie to the Census which also tells us that more than three-quarters of Singapore's people are of Chinese origin' (The Straits Times 1987a, 14). In 1989, a 'Chinatown disco' was held in conjunction with the Chinese New Year celebrations. Sponsored by the major Singaporean conglomerate Fraser and Neave, it was aimed at attracting young Chinese Singaporeans to Chinatown and reconnecting them with Chinese culture. However, the disco became a fiasco when concerned Singaporeans, in the name of valuing traditional Chinese culture, criticized it on the grounds that it was boosting Western culture instead. In response, district leaders stressed that traditional Chinese New Year songs would be played, and the venue would be decorated to 'give a total oriental atmosphere' (The Straits Times 1989a, 22). This act suggests, again, that the state or its agents would not hesitate to self-orientalize when the occasion arises.

尽管有这些令人沮丧的消息，旅游局和社区领袖从未放弃。为筹备1987年农历新年庆祝活动，他们在唐人街内设立了一个中华文化城，展示了各种各样的店铺，出售古董、中药材、盆景、点心和正在消失的工匠手工艺品。文化城被设计成一个"古雅的"、"典型的繁华中国小镇，32家店铺每家都将悬挂红色横幅，并带有自己的特色招牌"（The Straits Times 1986b, 32）。但尽管组织者尽了最大努力，"[唐人街的]农历新年似乎一年比一年安静，仿佛在揭穿人口普查的谎言——人口普查告诉我们新加坡超过四分之三的人口是华裔"（The Straits Times 1987a, 14）。1989年，一场"唐人街迪斯科"与农历新年庆祝活动结合举办。由新加坡大型财团星狮集团赞助，旨在吸引年轻的新加坡华人来到唐人街，让他们重新接触中国文化。然而，当忧心忡忡的新加坡人以重视中国传统文化为名，批评它反而在推广西方文化时，这场迪斯科变成了一场惨败。作为回应，街区领袖强调将播放传统农历新年歌曲，场地将被装饰成"营造完全的东方氛围"（The Straits Times 1989a, 22）。这一行为再次表明，国家或其代理人在时机成熟时会毫不犹豫地进行自我东方化。

The concerns of Chinese Singaporeans regarding the loss of their culture and heritage were not entirely unfounded. By 1989, a decade after launching the Speak Mandarin Campaign, ministers were urging clan associations to offer language classes to help raise the standard of Mandarin in Singapore. While Mandarin had replaced other Chinese languages as the lingua franca among Chinese Singaporeans, it was being slowly supplanted by English in business, government, and everyday life. Ministers thus hoped that clan associations could organize cultural performances and public forums to help 'preserve Chinese culture among Chinese Singaporeans' (The Straits Times

1989b, 12). During this time, the late 1980s and early 1990s, the government was worried that Singapore was becoming a Westernized society, whereby Singaporeans would become 'Asians looking like Asians and living in Asia but thinking and behaving like Americans or Britons' (Business Times 1989, 10). For 'traditionalist' Chinese Singaporeans, the annual Chinese New Year celebrations in Chinatown were a reassurance that the state was staying committed to preserving ethnic traditions and the 'Singaporean way of life' (Business Times 1989, 10). Therefore, tampering with the celebrations by introducing a disco, for example, was, to them, inappropriate: 'Where […] in particular is the Chineseness which should mark Lunar New Year when even skateboard and bicycle acrobatics can find a place in the [celebrations]?' (The Straits Times 1989c, 14). Ministers actually welcomed the public debates. One of them suggested that the heated discussion on having a makeshift disco in Chinatown showed that Chinese Singaporeans remained concerned about Chinese New Year. But it was also during this period they highlighted that 'the Lunar New Year was not a religious festival and the Chinese could celebrate it with their non-Chinese friends too' (The Straits Times 1989d, 11). At the same time as the state was fashioning Chinatown into a centre of Chinese culture, it was inviting other races to join the celebrations (The Straits Times 1989d, 11).

新加坡华人对其文化和遗产流失的担忧并非完全没有根据。到1989年，即讲华语运动发起十年后，部长们敦促会馆开设语言课程，以帮助提高新加坡的华语水平。虽然华语已经取代其他中国语言成为新加坡华人之间的通用语，但在商业、政府和日常生活中，它正逐渐被英语取代。部长们因此希望会馆能组织文化表演和公共论坛，以帮助"在新加坡华人中保护中国文化"（The Straits Times 1989b, 12）。在这个时期——二十世纪八十年代末九十年代初——政府担心新加坡正在变成一个西化社会，新加坡人将变成"长着亚洲人面孔、生活在亚洲，但思想和行为像美国人或英国人的亚洲人"（Business Times 1989, 10）。对于"传统主义"的新加坡华人来说，每年在唐人街举行的农历新年庆祝活动让他们放心，国家仍然致力于保护族群传统和"新加坡生活方式"（Business Times 1989, 10）。因此，比如通过引入迪斯科来干预庆祝活动，对他们来说是不合适的："当滑板和自行车杂技都能在[庆祝活动中]找到一席之地时，[……]标志着农历新年的华人特质究竟在哪里？"（The Straits Times 1989c, 14）。部长们实际上欢迎公开辩论。其中一位表示，关于在唐人街举办临时迪斯科的热烈讨论表明新加坡华人仍然关心农历新年。但也正是在这一时期，他们强调"农历新年不是一个宗教节日，华人也可以与他们的非华人朋友一起庆祝"（The Straits Times 1989d, 11）。在国家将唐人街打造成中国文化中心的同时，它也在邀请其他种族加入庆祝活动（The Straits Times 1989d, 11）。

The inclusion of new elements, even if they were unrelated to anything Chinese, was perhaps necessary because the new Chinatown was a hollow centre of Chinese culture, one that required the state to inject life and vibrancy annually so that it could remain, at least in some other aspects, a symbol of Chineseness in Singapore. The ban on firecrackers, clearance of street hawkers, and relocation of inhabitants, amongst other things, had deprived Chinatown of its organic elements and transformed it into a non-residential tourist attraction serving both locals and foreign visitors. State efforts in the name of national development, public health, and public safety actually 'softened the public's recollection of exactly what happened when crackers were

allowed,' and a cabinet minister recalled 'the good old days' when there was no ban (The Straits Times 1985c, 12). Some Chinese Singaporeans, whether or not they had experienced the celebrations in Chinatown of colonial and early independence years, evoked 'happy memories' of festivities 'quite unlike the celebrations of today [that were] sterile and commercialized' (The Straits Times 1987b, 6). Beginning in the early 2000s, in response to such sentiments, officials authorized the lighting of firecrackers by professional event organizers, under controlled conditions, in the annual celebrations (TODAY 2002, 1).

纳入新元素——即使它们与中国文化毫无关系——也许是必要的，因为新唐人街是一个中国文化的空心中心，需要国家每年注入生命力和活力，使其至少在某些方面仍然是新加坡华人特质的象征。鞭炮禁令、街头小贩清理和居民迁移等措施，剥夺了唐人街的有机元素，将其转变为一个服务于本地人和外国游客的非住宅旅游景点。以国家发展、公共卫生和公共安全为名的国家努力，实际上"软化了公众对允许燃放鞭炮时究竟发生了什么的记忆"，一位内阁部长回忆起没有禁令时的"美好旧时光"（The Straits Times 1985c, 12）。一些新加坡华人——无论是否经历过殖民时期和独立初期唐人街的庆祝活动——都唤起了对庆祝活动的"美好回忆"，说那"与今天[那种]枯燥和商业化的庆祝活动完全不同"（The Straits Times 1987b, 6）。从二十一世纪初开始，为回应这种情绪，官员们授权专业活动组织者在受控条件下，在年度庆祝活动中燃放鞭炮（TODAY 2002, 1）。

The scale and sophistication of Chinese New Year celebrations in Chinatown is possible because of the support of sponsors that take the opportunity to publicize their products and display their service to the community and nation. Cultural activities that appear intuitively 'Chinese,' such as calligraphy competitions, lantern riddles, and dragon and lion dances, held (only) during the festive season, often draw large crowds from other parts of Singapore. Food remains the key focus of the celebrations. The main streets of Chinatown are closed to motor traffic, and a legion of temporary vendors appear to receive the yearly wave of customers eager to buy New Year goodies and other tasty treats in preparation for the festival. In the cultural activities held in Chinatown, which display essentialist ideas of Chineseness, the multiplicity of meanings attached to the notion of Chinese identity is elided. Whether it is dance, opera, or acrobatics, it is called 'Chinese,' with little regard for its origins in, say, a county, province, or so-called dialect or subethnic group. That said, this is perhaps not the reason why Chinese Singaporeans appeared to be shunning Chinatown; they did not resist being lumped together as Chinese by their community and national leaders. The 'Mandarinization' of Chinese Singaporeans has been successful, and most Chinese Singaporeans, somewhat uncritically, assume a primordial relationship between Mandarin (as the Chinese language) and Chinese ethnicity (Wong and Tan 2017, 18–50). They value Mandarin for mainly instrumental reasons and can barely speak other Chinese languages or so-called dialects—their identity as Chinese Singaporeans, let alone as affiliates of some Chinese dialect or subethnic group, thus has little effect on their feelings toward Chinatown. Coupled with the participation of mainland Chinese performers in the cultural activities, the Chinese New Year celebrations are vehicles through which traditional Chinese culture is disseminated from supposedly more 'authentic custodians,' while constant references to ancient Chinese myths accentuate the authority of the generic Chineseness

represented by these activities (Anderson et al. 2019, 149). Such references to an abstracted and dehistoricized Chineseness further obscure the diversity of the community categorized as 'Chinese' in Singapore.

唐人街农历新年庆祝活动的规模和精致程度之所以可能，是因为有赞助商的支持——他们借此机会向社群和国家宣传自己的产品和展示服务。那些直观上显得"中国"的文化活动，如书法比赛、猜灯谜和舞龙舞狮，（仅）在节日期间举行，往往吸引来自新加坡其他地区的大量人群。食物仍然是庆祝活动的核心。唐人街的主要街道禁止机动车通行，大批临时摊贩出现，迎接每年一波急于购买年货和其他美味佳肴为节日做准备的顾客。在唐人街举办的文化活动中——这些活动展示了本质主义的华人特质观念——附着于华人身份概念的多重意义被抹去了。无论是舞蹈、戏曲还是杂技，都被称为"中国的"，几乎不考虑它起源于某个县、省或所谓的方言或次族群。也就是说，这也许不是新加坡华人似乎回避唐人街的原因；他们并不反对被社群和国家领导人笼统地归为华人。新加坡华人的"华语化"是成功的，大多数新加坡华人或多或少不加批判地假定华语（作为中文）与华族身份之间存在一种原生关系（Wong and Tan 2017, 18 – 50）。他们主要出于工具性原因重视华语，几乎不会说其他中国语言或所谓的方言——他们作为新加坡华人的身份，更不用说作为某个中国方言或次族群成员的身份，因此对他们对唐人街的感情几乎没有影响。加上中国大陆表演者参与文化活动，农历新年庆祝活动成为传播中国传统文化的载体——传播者据说是更"正宗的守护者"，而不断引用中国古代神话则强化了这些活动所代表的一般化华人特质的权威性（Anderson et al. 2019, 149）。这种对抽象化和去历史化的华人特质的引用，进一步遮蔽了新加坡被归类为"华人"的社群的多样性。

With the influx of new Chinese immigrants from mainland China during the 2000s, the ethnic Chinese population of Singapore became more differentiated, and Chinatown has since been dominated by mainland Chinese businesses, restaurants, and retail operators. So many are the new immigrants that they have branched out to form an unofficial, even newer Chinatown in the Geylang district east of the city centre (Ang 2018). The differences between the so-called old and new Chinese diasporas have disrupted the meaning of Chineseness in Singapore. The Chineseness of the revamped Chinatown has not only been orientalized to attract tourists, but it has also come to represent mainland Chinese culture and traditions—assumed to be more authentic because they are practiced by so-called natives of the perceived homeland of all Chinese—rather than the 'stuff' that had characterized the lives of Chinese sojourners and settlers under colonial rule. No longer the community of 'original' Chinese immigrants and their descendants, Chinatown has turned into a highly commercialized and visible 'China's Town' that renders talk of a uniform Chinese population in Singapore meaningless. Singaporeans, both Chinese and non-Chinese, can no longer easily distinguish between what may be called 'native' Singaporean Chinese (Chinese overseas), Chinese nationals (overseas Chinese), and ethnic Chinese from other parts of the world. Lumping them all together as 'Chinese' is thus misleading, but isolating alien residents from China for public discussion risks stoking fears or prejudices that border on racism. When conceived in its diasporic and transnational context, then, Singapore's Chinatown is a 'complex sedimentation of multiple—and sometimes contradictory—traces, in a global city that is itself coming to terms with the emerging age of China' (Anderson et al. 2019, 83). The key question becomes whether mainland Chinese influence could really dominate and sub-

sume other Chinese cultures and identities in Chinatown and, more broadly, in Singapore because the existing Chinese Singaporeans do not consider the new immigrants from China their own.

随着二十一世纪中国大陆新移民的涌入，新加坡华族人口变得更加分化，唐人街从此被中国大陆的商家、餐馆和零售商所主导。新移民数量如此之多，以至于他们向外扩展，在市中心以东的芽笼区形成了一个非正式的、更新的唐人街（Ang 2018）。所谓的新旧华人离散群体之间的差异，扰乱了新加坡华人特质的意义。改造后的唐人街的华人特质不仅被东方化以吸引游客，它也开始代表中国大陆的文化和传统——这些被认为更正宗，因为它们是由所谓全体华人想象中的家园的"本地人"所实践的——而不是殖民统治时期华人旅居者和移民生活的那些"东西"。唐人街不再是"原始"华人移民及其后代的社群，而是变成了一个高度商业化和显眼的"中国城"，使得关于新加坡存在统一华人人口的说法变得毫无意义。新加坡人——无论华人还是非华人——再也无法轻易区分所谓的"本土"新加坡华人（海外华人）、中国公民（侨居海外的中国人）以及来自世界其他地区的华族。将他们全部归为"华人"因此是误导性的，但将来自中国的外来居民单独挑出来进行公开讨论，又有可能激起近乎种族主义的恐惧或偏见。那么，当在其离散和跨国背景下来理解时，新加坡的唐人街就是"一个多重——有时是相互矛盾的——痕迹的复杂沉淀，存在于一个本身正在适应中国崛起时代的全球城市之中"（Anderson et al. 2019, 83）。关键问题变成了：中国大陆的影响是否真的能在唐人街乃至更广泛的新加坡主导并吞并其他华人文化和身份，因为现有的新加坡华人并不认为来自中国的新移民是自己人。

But Singapore's exchanges with China have remained predominantly economic, if not utilitarian; the Chinese New Year celebrations are a rare instance of the relationship moving beyond the purely material and an excellent opportunity for China to improve its image among Chinese Singaporeans. In everyday interactions of recent years, unhappiness among Chinese Singaporeans toward Chinese citizens residing in their neighbourhood has grown. For them, Chinese citizens have not quite blended well in Singaporean society and have brought instead a host of social problems, from causing property prices to skyrocket to being intolerant of local culinary preferences. Although official Sino-Singapore diplomatic relations remain reasonably strong, the resentment of Chinese Singaporeans at the behaviour and perceived cultural arrogance of Chinese citizens may nonetheless sustain or reinforce the negative stereotypes of Chinese citizens living in Singapore; it is also possible that Chinese citizens think that Chinese Singaporeans are culturally and ethnically less authentic and hence no longer real 'Chinese' like themselves (Ho 2016, 152–3).

但新加坡与中国的交流主要仍是经济上的，甚至是功利性的；农历新年庆祝活动是这种关系超越纯粹物质层面的罕见例子，也是中国改善其在新加坡华人中形象的绝佳机会。在近年来的日常互动中，新加坡华人对居住在其社区的中国公民的不满情绪有所增长。对他们来说，中国公民并没有很好地融入新加坡社会，反而带来了一系列社会问题，从导致房价飙升到不能容忍当地的饮食偏好。尽管中新官方外交关系仍然相当牢固，但新加坡华人对中国公民行为和所感知的文化傲慢的怨恨，可能会维持或强化对居住在新加坡的中国公民的负面刻板印象；中国公民也有可能认为新加坡华人在文化和族群上不那么正宗，因此不再是像他们自己一样真正的"华人"（Ho 2016, 152 – 3）。

Thus, within this evolving assemblage lies a Chinatown that is experiencing and anticipating a broader 'Sinicization' of Singapore as a global city. Given China's increasing global clout that could have great cultural, economic, and

social implications for Singapore, Chinatown is no longer seen—at least from the state perspective—as an exotic, problematic, or threatening other, but as a part of the 'mundane cosmopolitan interactions' of the city centre (Anderson et al. 2019, 89). One such interaction occurs every year in Chinatown's Chinese New Year celebrations (Kong and Yeoh 1997). One of the most important dimensions of the festival is its role in cultivating diplomatic ties with China, which sends performers, supplies, and visitors to participate in the festivities. Statements of friendship and mutual appreciation are exchanged to cement relations, and Chineseness is leveraged and performed at the national and even global levels. But as the festival becomes more professionalized and commercially promoted, its links with the local Chinese community have become less prominent. Community members apparently have little say in its planning and execution. Officials, very often even cabinet ministers, sit on the organizing committees as well as approve and officiate Chinese New Year activities. By actively participating in the events, the government is both courting and disciplining the key organizers and sponsors of the celebrations, most notably the clan associations and the Singapore Chinese Chamber of Commerce and Industry, in the hope of aligning them with major state objectives such as social integration (Visscher 2007, 128–176). Moreover, the convergence of national interests between China and Singapore in forging a singular Chinese community—from scratch—has diluted the role and sway of dialect groups and local associations in the celebrations. But efforts to 'Sinicize' the ethnic Chinese in Singapore have been complicated by the multiracial ethos of the postcolonial nation. The Chingay Parade, which celebrates the birthdays of well-known Chinese deities and concludes the celebrations every year, highlights the complications and tensions.

因此，在这个不断演变的集合体中，存在着一个正在经历并期待着新加坡作为全球城市更广泛"中国化"的唐人街。鉴于中国日益增长的全球影响力——这可能对新加坡产生重大的文化、经济和社会影响——唐人街不再被视为（至少从国家角度来看）一个异国情调的、有问题的或具有威胁性的他者，而是市中心"日常世界主义互动"的一部分（Anderson et al. 2019, 89）。每年在唐人街的农历新年庆祝活动中就发生着这样一种互动（Kong and Yeoh 1997）。这个节日最重要的维度之一是它在培育与中国外交关系中的作用，中国会派遣表演者、物资和访客参与庆祝活动。双方互致友谊和赞赏的声明以巩固关系，华人特质在国家甚至全球层面被利用和表演。但随着节日变得更加专业化和商业化推广，它与本地华人社群的联系变得不那么突出了。社群成员显然在其策划和执行中几乎没有发言权。官员——往往甚至是内阁部长——担任组织委员会成员，并批准和主持农历新年活动。通过积极参与这些活动，政府既在拉拢又在规训庆祝活动的主要组织者和赞助商，特别是会馆和新加坡中华总商会，希望使它们与社会融合等国家主要目标保持一致（Visscher 2007, 128 – 176）。此外，中国和新加坡在从零开始打造一个单一华人社群方面的国家利益趋同，削弱了方言群体和本地社团在庆祝活动中的角色和影响力。但是，将新加坡华族"中国化"的努力因后殖民国家的多种族精神而变得复杂。每年庆祝中国著名神祇诞辰并为庆祝活动画上句号的妆艺大游行，凸显了这种复杂性和紧张关系。

5
A Multiracial Chinese Parade

五
多种族的华人游行

The Chingay Parade is a major highlight of Singapore's Chinese New Year celebrations. Held on the last night of the celebrations, Chingay features a procession of lavishly decorated floats, sponsored by big companies and government organizations, that travels through the streets of Chinatown and the main roads of the city centre. It ends with a fireworks display that lights up the night skyline of Singapore. Aware of the tourist dollars Chingay attracts, state organizers have turned it into an international spectacle celebrating Singapore as a 'cosmopolitan global city of hybridizing multiculturalism'; it is no longer a strictly Chinese affair (Goh 2011). Theatrical and carnival-like displays of different cultural motifs, carefully selected by the organizers to give equal emphasis to the officially recognized races, signify a focus away from the exclusive exhibition of 'Chinese' culture expected of the celebrations. The postcolonial state organizes parades such as Chingay to 'materialize and legitimize official versions of multiculturalism' (Goh 2011, 112), which has developed into a tradition of its own.

> 妆艺大游行是新加坡农历新年庆祝活动的一大亮点。在庆祝活动的最后一晚举行，妆艺游行以大型公司和政府组织赞助的装饰华丽的花车队伍为特色，穿过唐人街的街道和市中心的主要道路。最后以烟花表演结束，照亮新加坡的夜空。意识到妆艺游行吸引的旅游收入，国家组织者已将其变成一个国际盛事，将新加坡赞美为"融合多元文化主义的世界主义全球城市"；它不再是纯粹的华人活动（Goh 2011）。由组织者精心挑选、对官方承认的各种种族给予同等重视的不同文化主题的戏剧化和狂欢式展示，标志着焦点已从庆祝活动本应呈现的纯粹"中国"文化展览转移开。后殖民国家组织妆艺这样的游行，是为了"将官方版本的多元文化主义物质化并使其合法化"（Goh 2011, 112），这已发展成为一种自身的传统。

Chingay started in 1973, when the Singaporean government decided to adopt for the Chinese New Year celebrations a creolized version of street processions enacted by Hokkiens during religious festivals and special events (Goh 2011, 120). State organizers, with the consent and assistance of local community leaders in Chinatown and surrounding districts, cleansed Chingay of its religious character to express a secular Chinese identity. They removed the spiritualist element that usually headed the old processions, whether a wooden boat, religious artefact, or spirit-medium in trance leading the floats. Rather than being attired to pray for peace, Chingay was dressed up for a masquerade. The secular Chingay, with its gaiety and noise, was intended to compensate for the ban on firecrackers (Goh 2011, 120). Ministers and officials also believed that Chingay could modernize Chinese New Year celebrations. By 'reviving' Chingay in secular form, the state could claim to patronize 'authentic' Chinese traditions (Goh 2011, 121). At its inception, calls for making it a multiracial event emerged. In convenient response to such calls, state organizers began to transform Chingay into a vehicle of national multiracialism. The annual iterations of Chingay 'signified the perennial nation, if not existing in the imagination from time immemorial, then extending into the immortal future as the transcendental community' (Goh 2011, 122–3). The nationalistic aspects of Chingay were thus obvious.

妆艺游行始于1973年，当时新加坡政府决定在农历新年庆祝活动中采用一种克里奥尔化版本的街头游行——这种游行原本是福建人在宗教节日和特殊活动中表演的（Goh 2011, 120）。国家组织者在唐人街及周边地区本地社区领袖的同意和协助下，清除了妆艺游行的宗教色彩，以表达一种世俗的华人身份。他们移除了通常在旧游行队伍前面的通灵元素——无论是木船、宗教神器还是引领花车的出神灵媒。妆艺游行不再穿着祈求平安的服饰，而是打扮成化装舞会的样子。世俗化的妆艺游行以其欢乐和喧闹，旨在弥补鞭炮禁令的缺失（Goh 2011, 120）。部长和官员们也相信妆艺游行可以使农历新年庆祝活动现代化。通过以世俗形式"复兴"妆艺游行，国家可以声称在赞助"正宗的"中国传统（Goh 2011, 121）。在其创立之初，就出现了将其打造为多种族活动的呼声。为了方便地回应这些呼声，国家组织者开始将妆艺游行转变为国家多种族主义的载体。每年一届的妆艺游行"象征着永恒的国家——即使不是从远古时代就存在于想象中，也作为超越性社群延伸至不朽的未来"（Goh 2011, 122 – 3）。妆艺游行的民族主义面向因此是显而易见的。

Over time, however, the state would dilute these aspects by globalizing Chingay. Beginning in the late 1980s, the Singaporean government worked to transform the economy into a postindustrial mode. Chingay became part of its strategy to transform Singapore into a global city of commerce, finance, fine arts, and upscale living, one that could attract talented cosmopolitans to work or settle in Singapore. In recent years, Chingay has also moved to public housing estates, albeit on a smaller and less spectacular scale. Symbolic authority has cascaded down the bureaucratic hierarchy to a so-called network model that connects autonomous organizations outside direct state supervision to achieve the carnival effect. Chingay floats are no longer assigned to government-linked grassroots organizations but are selected from proposals by non-governmental civic, commercial, educational, and religious institutions (Goh 2011, 128). Local grassroots institutions, which enjoy a fair degree of autonomy in everyday governance despite being part of the state, organize sidewalk carnivals, or mini-Chingays, in the public housing estates. Far cheaper to put together than Chingay, these events are often accompanied by flea markets and stage performances of dance and song, which are more interactive than the barricaded Chingay for tourists and purportedly more sophisticated Singaporeans. For their strong vernacular feel and less restrained gaiety, the sidewalk carnivals actually resemble the old Hokkien religious and street processions more strongly than Chingay. But given the international publicity and state recognition of Chingay, most Singaporeans still accord it a higher status than its 'poor imitations' in the residential neighbourhoods (Goh 2011, 129).

然而随着时间的推移，国家通过将妆艺游行全球化来稀释这些面向。从二十世纪八十年代末开始，新加坡政府努力将经济转变为后工业模式。妆艺游行成为其将新加坡转型为商业、金融、美术和高端生活全球城市战略的一部分——一个能够吸引有才华的世界主义者来新加坡工作或定居的城市。近年来，妆艺游行也走进了公共组屋区，尽管规模较小、场面不那么壮观。象征性权威沿着官僚等级层层下放到所谓的网络模式，连接国家直接监管之外的自主组织以实现狂欢效果。妆艺花车不再分配给政府关联的基层组织，而是从非政府的民间、商业、教育和宗教机构的提案中选出（Goh 2011, 128）。地方基层机构虽然是国家的一部分，但在日常治理中享有相当程度的自主权，它们在公共组屋区组织街头嘉年华或迷你妆艺游行。这些活动的举办成本远低于妆艺大游行，通常伴随着跳蚤市场和歌舞舞台表演——与为游客和据说更"精致"的新加坡人设置围栏的妆艺大游行相比，这些活动更具互动性。由于强烈的乡土气息和不那么拘谨的欢乐氛围，街头嘉年华实际上比妆艺大游行更接近旧的福建宗教和街头游行。但鉴于妆艺大游行的国际知名度和国家认可，大多数新加坡人

仍然认为它比住宅区里那些"寒酸的模仿品"地位更高（Goh 2011, 129）。

In Chinatown's Chingay parade, non-Chinese floats have included Malay cultural organizations' portrayal of Sang Nila Utama's founding of premodern Singapore, Indian dancers from Indian fine arts societies, and both Indian and Malay folk performances. While individual Chinese groups have not disputed being incorporated into the parade as 'Chinese' rather than as their subethnic identities (which, again, points to the success of the Mandarinization and Sinicization of Chinese Singaporeans), some Indian Singaporeans are allegedly upset at the double standard: Chingay, despite its celebration of Singapore's ethnic diversity, is still considered 'Chinese' in nature, while their own Thaipusam festival has remained classified a religious ritual, even though it has shed many of its religious elements and developed into a cultural display of Indian identity. The distinction between culture and religion is crucial—the authorities have argued that the playing of musical instruments, a key component of festivities, should apply to only cultural processions such as Chingay but not to religious ones such as Thaipusam (Sykes 2015, 398). The existence of lingering voices of discontent suggests the need for the state to continue its ideological work, through the census, ethnographical writings, and urban planning, in order to define diverse ethnicities into the racial categories of 'Chinese,' 'Malay,' 'Indian,' and 'Others' that has provided the framework for government (Goh 2011, 114). Creative work has gone into Chingay to put this framework on display. Ascriptive multiracialism is the key principle in organizing Chingay, and the preservation of ethnic heritage functions to emotively bind middle-class Singaporeans to their nation (Goh 2013, 230).

在唐人街的妆艺游行中，非华人花车包括马来文化组织对山尼拉乌他玛建立前现代新加坡的演绎、来自印度美术协会的印度舞者，以及印度和马来的民间表演。虽然各个华人群体并未对被笼统地作为"华人"而非其次族群身份纳入游行提出异议（这再次表明新加坡华人的华语化和中国化是成功的），但据说一些印度族新加坡人对这种双重标准感到不满：妆艺游行尽管庆祝新加坡的族群多样性，本质上仍被视为"华人的"，而他们自己的大宝森节却一直被归类为宗教仪式——尽管它已经摆脱了许多宗教元素，发展成为印度身份的文化展示。文化与宗教之间的区分至关重要——当局认为，演奏乐器作为庆祝活动的关键组成部分，应只适用于妆艺游行这样的文化游行，而不适用于大宝森节这样的宗教游行（Sykes 2015, 398）。持续存在的不满声音表明，国家需要继续其意识形态工作——通过人口普查、民族志写作和城市规划——将多元的族群定义为"华人"、"马来人"、"印度人"和"其他"的种族类别，这些类别为政府提供了框架（Goh 2011, 114）。妆艺游行投入了大量创意工作来展示这一框架。归因性多种族主义是组织妆艺游行的关键原则，而族群遗产的保护在情感上将中产阶级新加坡人与他们的国家绑定在一起（Goh 2013, 230）。

Chingay, and Singapore's Chinatown and Chinese New Year celebrations that it represents, is similar to what literary scholar Mary Louise Pratt has called a 'contact zone,' where cultures meet, clash, and grapple with each other (Pratt 1991, 34). The use of the concept here requires some modification or qualification. In its original usage, contact zone is applied to the imperial context, whereby power and sovereignty are negotiated when previously separate societies come into contact. In postcolonial Singapore, the state actually replicates colonial practice and refashions Chingay into a 're-contact zone' where eth-

nic groups, already living together, gather again for a spectacle within which, ironically, official claims may be contested. Chingay is no longer solely or exclusively 'Chinese' and serves the national interests of courting foreign talent and keeping a multiracial nation together. It expresses trans-Asian connections across national borders and remains an Oriental carnival and spectacle. But given that it has been the state's intention to turn Chinatown and Chingay into transnational tapestries of multiculturalism, cosmopolitanism does not, as some scholars suggest (Beck and Sznaider 2010, 400), negate or presuppose nationalism. Chingay is also a 'border of memory' where competition over social memory emerges (Boyle 2019, 300). Chinatown and the Chinese New Year celebrations that characterize the site are spaces of mnemonic encounter and practice, where different kinds and levels of collective memories jostle for official endorsement or mere preservation in social practices.[2] Memories are alive only when they remain within bounds, which are, at least in the context of postcolonial Singapore, defined by the state. To that effect, Chinatown is a consecrated site that embodies fading memories (Nora 1996), which are emptied of any real significance and homogenized for justifications of the nation's origins and its linear, somewhat natural trajectory to its present state (see Figure 3.2).

妆艺游行，以及它所代表的新加坡唐人街和农历新年庆祝活动，类似于文学学者玛丽·路易丝·普拉特所说的"接触地带"——文化在那里相遇、碰撞和相互角力（Pratt 1991, 34）。在这里使用这个概念需要一些修正或限定。在其原始用法中，接触地带应用于帝国背景，即以前分离的社会接触时，权力和主权在其中被协商。在新加坡后殖民时期，国家实际上复制了殖民做法，将妆艺游行重塑为一个"再接触地带"——已经生活在一起的各族群再次聚集在一个盛景中，具有讽刺意味的是，在这个盛景中，官方主张可能受到挑战。妆艺游行不再仅仅或专门是"华人的"，而是服务于招揽外国人才和维系多种族国家的国家利益。它表达了跨越国界的跨亚洲联系，仍然是一个东方嘉年华和盛景。但鉴于国家一直有意将唐人街和妆艺游行变成多元文化主义的跨国织锦，世界主义并不像一些学者所说的那样（Beck and Sznaider 2010, 400）否定或预设民族主义。妆艺游行也是一个"记忆的边界"，社会记忆的竞争在那里出现（Boyle 2019, 300）。唐人街和以其为特色的农历新年庆祝活动是记忆相遇和实践的空间，不同类型和层次的集体记忆在那里争夺官方认可或仅仅在社会实践中得以保存。[2] 记忆只有在边界内才是鲜活的——而这些边界，至少在新加坡后殖民背景下，是由国家定义的。为此，唐人街是一个神圣化的场所，体现着正在消逝的记忆（Nora 1996）——这些记忆被抽空了任何真正的意义，并被同质化，为国家的起源及其线性的、某种程度上自然的发展轨迹提供辩护（见图3.2）。

For Chinese Singaporeans, then, what is Chingay about? Is it Chinese, cosmopolitan, Hokkien, multiracial, or Singaporean? As a border of memory, Chingay exists among memory communities invested in the heritage of Chinatown and the symbolic meanings of Chinese New Year celebrations. Although the official narrative that Chingay is both cosmopolitan and multiracial remains dominant, it does not prevent Chinese Singaporeans from forming their own impressions of the parade. To begin with, many non-Chinese, even Chinese themselves, have not fully understood the reasons for celebrating Chingay or the Chinese New Year (The Straits Times 1985e, 20). Some spectators 'hardly cheered, laughed or waved when the participants performed before them' (The Straits Times 1986a, 14). And as if to confirm the success

of their own Mandarinization and Sinicization, other spectators propose renaming the parade 'Zhuang Yi' to align it with the Speak Mandarin policy (The Straits Times 1987c, 20). Paradoxically, then, Chingay has become a victim of its own success. Many Chinese Singaporeans have become ethnically apathetic and are barely conscious of their identity as Chinese, let alone as Cantonese, Hokkien, Teochew, or others. Although they still possess a vague idea of what being Chinese entails, they identify Chingay as a 'priceless part of our [national] heritage' (TODAY 2007, 18) and struggle for a deep appreciation of Chingay's cultural motifs, most of which originating in supposedly Hokkien or Fujianese traditions. Apathy and ignorance have thus characterized many Chinese Singaporeans' impressions of Chingay. The competition, or lack thereof, over interpretations renders Chingay a border of memory among both Chinese and non-Chinese Singaporeans.

那么，对新加坡华人来说，妆艺游行究竟是关于什么的？它是华人的、世界主义的、福建的、多种族的，还是新加坡的？作为记忆的边界，妆艺游行存在于那些投入于唐人街遗产和农历新年庆祝活动象征意义的记忆社群之中。尽管妆艺游行既是世界主义的又是多种族的这一官方叙事仍然占主导地位，但这并不妨碍新加坡华人形成自己对游行的印象。首先，许多非华人，甚至华人自己，都没有完全理解庆祝妆艺游行或农历新年的原因（The Straits Times 1985e, 20）。一些观众"在参与者面前表演时，几乎不欢呼、不笑、也不挥手"（The Straits Times 1986a, 14）。而似乎是为了确认他们自己的华语化和中国化的成功，另一些观众提议将游行改名为"妆艺"（Zhuang Yi），使其与讲华语政策保持一致（The Straits Times 1987c, 20）。因此，矛盾的是，妆艺游行成了自身成功的受害者。许多新加坡华人在族群上变得冷漠，几乎意识不到自己的华人身份，更不用说广府人、福建人、潮州人或其他身份了。虽然他们对作为华人意味着什么仍有一个模糊的概念，但他们将妆艺游行视为"我们[国家]遗产中无价的一部分"（TODAY 2007, 18），却难以深刻理解妆艺游行的文化主题——其中大部分起源于所谓的福建人传统。因此，冷漠和无知构成了许多新加坡华人对妆艺游行印象的特征。对解释的竞争——或缺乏竞争——使妆艺游行成为新加坡华人和非华人之间的一个记忆边界。



Figure 3.2 A float at Chingay, an increasingly cosmopolitan event in Singapore
图3.2 妆艺游行中的花车，新加坡一个日益世界主义的活动
Courtesy of Wikimedia

图片来源：维基共享资源

6
Conclusion
六
结论

Singapore's Chinatown has had an interesting history. Originally an urban enclave of sojourners and settlers from China during colonial times, Chinatown was purged of its inhabitants and their culture, traditions, and heritage in the wake of Singapore's independence. At almost the same time, however, the Singaporean government took steps to re-create Chinatown as a heritage site and argued that it remained the bastion of Chineseness. The official narrative rang hollow in the face of public scepticism supported by fading memories and oral histories and was shot in the foot by a gradual shift in the government's stance toward multiracialism. Yet the state's embrace of multiracialism also meant that Chinatown received a facelift and official recognition guaranteeing its continued existence as a tool for nation-building. With tourism added to the mix, Chinatown and the annual Chinese New Year celebrations held in the district assumed a cosmopolitan, specifically trans-Asian, look incorporating the essentialized motifs of Singapore's legally prescribed races while downplaying the predominance of Chinese elements. Addressing both domestic sensibilities and global appeal, the celebrations culminating in the Chingay parade every year have never been excessive displays of Chineseness. Rather, the celebrations have been increasingly shaped by economic interests, polit-

ical calibrations, and racial sensitivities, creating a spectacle that represents the state's cultural discourse and the public's general acceptance of that discourse. Some cynicism and indifference nonetheless have existed to challenge the essentialized idea of static and unchanging cultural identities—indifference could well be a form of cynicism in itself. More and more Chinese Singaporeans go on overseas vacations during the Chinese New Year season, believing that the family bonding so prided in Chinese culture can take place abroad—Chinatown, Chingay, and other more 'national' or physical manifestations matter less and less to them (The Straits Times 2016). That said, the commercialization, politicization, and racialization of the celebrations have transformed Chinatown into a multiracial heritage site and the Chinese New Year celebrations there into multiracial festivities that, notwithstanding the persisting contradictions and tensions, have confirmed the state as a dominant arbiter of all racial discourses, identities, and expressions in Singapore.

新加坡唐人街有着一段有趣的历史。它最初是殖民时期来自中国的旅居者和移民的城市飞地，在新加坡独立后，唐人街的居民及其文化、传统和遗产被清除。然而几乎在同时，新加坡政府采取措施将唐人街重新打造为一个遗产地，并主张它仍然是华人特质的堡垒。面对由 fading memories 和口述史支撑的公众怀疑，官方叙事显得空洞，而政府对多种族主义立场的逐渐转变更是弄巧成拙。然而，国家对多种族主义的拥抱也意味着唐人街得到了翻新和官方认可，保证了它作为国家建构工具的持续存在。随着旅游业加入其中，唐人街和每年在该街区举行的农历新年庆祝活动呈现出一种世界主义的——特别是跨亚洲的——面貌，融合了新加坡法定各种族的本质化主题，同时弱化了华人元素的主导地位。同时兼顾国内情感和全球吸引力，每年以妆艺大游行达到高潮的庆祝活动，从来不是对华人特质的过度展示。相反，庆祝活动越来越受到经济利益、政治考量和种族敏感性的塑造，创造出一种代表国家文化话语以及公众对该话语普遍接受的盛景。尽管如此，仍然存在一些冷嘲热讽和冷漠，挑战着静态不变的文化身份这一本质化观念——冷漠本身很可能就是一种冷嘲热讽的形式。越来越多的新加坡华人在农历新年期间出国度假，认为中国文化中如此引以为豪的家庭团聚可以在国外进行——唐人街、妆艺游行和其他更具"国家性"或实体性的表现形式对他们来说越来越不重要（The Straits Times 2016）。话虽如此，庆祝活动的商业化、政治化和种族化，已将唐人街转变为一个多种族遗产地，将那里的农历新年庆祝活动转变为多种族节日——尽管存在持续的矛盾和紧张，但它们确认了国家作为新加坡所有种族话语、身份和表达的主导仲裁者的地位。